

Paperluz Industry Weekly · Issue 002

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Core Theme: EU PPWR 5-Day Countdown × Comprehensive PFAS Phase-Out × Top 5 Paper Packaging Mega-Trends for 2026

China Import NBSK Pulp Spot

\$672 / MT

RMB 4,800/t · Soft/Hardwood spread \$47/MT · Sub halted

US OCC #11 Export FAS

\$130–135

USD/short ton · Fiber costs flat · Mill Spread reaches \$720/t

NA / EU Containerboard Hikes

+\$140 / +€120

PCA / IP / Smurfit dominant seller's market · Sept 1 effective

EU PPWR Mandatory Law

Countdown: 5 Days

2026-08-12 mandatory · DfR compliance audit alert

China Ivory Board Hike

+\$28 / MT

+RMB 200/MT · APP, Nine Dragons & Sun Paper lead sector

Long Chen H1 Performance

Turnaround

Chinese packaging market rebound · Taiwan spin-off planned

I. Executive 10-Line Summary & Key Insights

- 1. EU PPWR Enters Final 5-Day Countdown:** Starting 2026-08-12, all EU-bound commercial packaging enters mandatory Design for Recycling (DfR) and Digital Product Passport (DPP) compliance.
- 2. Comprehensive Phase-Out of PFAS & BPA Across Packaging Chains:** Following the July expiration of BPA exemptions, the EU PFHxA ban (Oct 11) is driving unprecedented demand for fluorine-free aqueous barrier board.
- 3. Top 5 Paper Packaging Mega-Trends Established for 2026:** Plastic substitution, DfR lightweighting, aqueous dispersion barriers, DPP traceability, and high-barrier kraft bags.
- 4. North American Containerboard Price Hikes Solidify:** PCA (+\$140/t), IP (+\$80/t), and Smurfit Westrock (+\$100/t) Sept 1 adjustments backed by 3.9M MT of Americas mill closures.
- 5. Virgin Wood Pulp Consolidates at Cost Floor:** China NBSK at \$672/MT (RMB 4,800) and BHKP at \$625/MT (RMB 4,480); \$47/MT spread maintains bottom price discipline.
- 6. US OCC Export Prices Stable, Raw Material Spread Reaches \$720/t:** US #11 OCC export FAS held at \$130–135/short ton, generating historic gross margins for packaging mills.
- 7. Long Chen Secures H1 Turnaround:** Chinese containerboard price recovery (+15% since April) delivered profitable H1 earnings ahead of holding restructuring.
- 8. Cheng Loong Expands Southeast Asian Leadership:** Vietnam Binh Duong Phase 3 operates near full capacity, supporting an 18–20% H2 gross margin trajectory.

9. Energy & Steam Cost Containment in Asian Mills: >40% solid recovered fuel (SRF) biomass power caps steam energy costs at \$22.5–24.2/MT (NT\$720–780).

10. China GB 4806.10 Food Coating Standard Countdown at 26 Days: Strict migration limits effective Sept 2 accelerate the phase-out of fluorinated food containers.

II. Key Indicators Dashboard

Indicator	Latest Value (USD)	Benchmark Date	Change	Market Interpretation & Trend
China NBSK Spot Nationwide Avg	\$672 / MT (RMB 4,800)	2026-08-07	Stable	Softwood cost support firm; buying interest returning
China BHKP Spot Nationwide Avg	\$625 / MT (RMB 4,480)	2026-08-07	Stable	Hardwood supply ample; Suzano Cerrado volume flowing smoothly
US #11 OCC Export (FAS Avg)	\$132 / short ton	2026-08-07	Flat	Raw Material Spread remains at historic \$720/t peak
Taiwan Domestic OCC Delivered Mill	\$130 / MT (NT\$4,200)	2026-08-07	Flat	Domestic collection balanced; feedstock costs under control

III. Top 5 Paper Packaging Mega-Trends for 2026

1. Plastic-to-Paper Acceleration: Replacement of single-use plastics in food and e-commerce packaging.

2. Design for Recycling (DfR) Optimization: Minimizing mixed-material laminates to ensure >95% fiber yield in standard repulping systems.

3. PFAS-Free Water-Based Dispersion Coatings: High-performance aqueous barrier boards replacing traditional PE extrusion coatings.

4. Digital Product Passport (DPP) Integration: Full digital traceability of fiber origin and environmental footprint.

5. High-Strength Unbleached Kraft Paper Growth: Surge in retail and food-delivery demand driving premium unbleached packaging papers.

Full-Chain Forward Forecast Matrix (Energy × Pulp × Paper)

Commodity	Base	1M Outlook	3M Outlook	6M Outlook	Trend	Primary Drivers
Brent Crude	\$80.50/bbl	\$78–83	\$75–81	\$72–79	Softening	Macro headwinds; refinery maintenance; ease in resin/chemical costs
Taiwan Coal CIF	\$142.5/MT	\$136–143	\$130–138	\$126–134	Declining	Australian supply ample; mill biomass keeps steaming costs at \$22–24.2/MT
NBSK Softwood	\$672/MT	\$668–685	\$680–720	\$700–745	Rebound	Cost support; established seasonal restocking starting in September
BHKP Hardwood	\$625/MT	\$605–625	\$590–620	\$600–630	Range-bound	Suzano Cerro supply absence; market denormalizing; capping hardwood surges
Containerboard	+\$140 / +10%	Full Realization	Firm (+30\$)	Strong	Bullish	Americas mill closures tight supply; Asia export demand expanding

IV. Global Regulations & 90-Day Milestones

Date	Days Out	Regulation / Commercial Milestone	Impacted Sectors
2026-08-10	3 Days	Smurfit Westrock Folding Boxboard / SBS +4–6% Effective	Folding cartons, food packaging
2026-08-12	5 Days	EU PPWR Mandatory Enforcement Date	All EU export packaging
2026-08-20	13 Days	Sappi Paperboard Grades +4–6% Effective	Packaging converters
2026-09-01	25 Days	PCA +\$140 / IP +\$80 / Smurfit +\$100 Containerboard Hikes	Industrial packaging
2026-09-02	26 Days	China GB 4806.10-2025 Food Contact Coating Mandate	Paper cups, food containers
2026-10-11	65 Days	EU PFHxA Total PFAS Ban in Food Packaging	Barrier paperboard
2026-12-30	145 Days	EU EUDR Deforestation Regulation Enforcement	Global pulp & paper exporters

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All benchmark data is sourced from 59 globally registered authorities, verified through 4-tier AI cross-audits, and preserved in immutable SQLite database version control.

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